8. Where can I find support?

Seeking support will always be a personal decision, you can access it when you are ready to. All the options below are available to you regardless of when an incident happened, and you don't have to formally report it to get support. While these resources are not specific to spiking, they can still provide valuable support.

8.1. Support at University

Your university is likely to have a counselling and wellbeing service and may have other support services for issues such as sexual violence or harassment.

You should be able to find information and links to these services on your university's website, or if you are a student, your student homepage. You can also reach out to your personal tutor or student services team for support or referral to additional services.

For ARU students[17]

You can reach out to the student services team in-person at the iCentre or online through Ask ARU. You can find out who your Personal Development Tutor (PDT) is from e:Vision, and contact them.

Counselling and Wellbeing one-to-one support is available from counsellors or mental health advisers through drop-ins either via telephone or video call. You can email wellbeing@aru.ac.uk or complete a referral form online. There are also workshops and online resources available.

Sexual Violence Support – the Sexual Violence Advocacy Service (SVA) can offer practical support and advocacy for any student who has been subjected to sexual violence, no matter when or where it happened. You can self-refer online or contact sva@aru.ac.uk to book one of the drop-in sessions.

8.2. External support – victims of any crime

Victim Support[18] –They support people affected by crime or traumatic incidents. They offer a telephone support line and live chat, as well as specific local hubs (e.g. Cambridgeshire and Essex). Additionally, they offer a range of online resources.

My Support Space[20]– A free online platform that offers a range of tools to help you cope and move forwards after any crime.

Victim Services for Cambridgeshire and Peterborough[21] – They provide emotional and practical support for victims/survivors and witnesses of crime in Cambridgeshire and Peterborough, with an online support directory, phoneline and email.

Sexual Assault Referral Centres (SARCs)[22]- If you think you were spiked and it led to you being sexually assaulted, you can also go to a SARC for specialist care, support and advice. They will also be able to conduct a forensic medical examination if you decide you want one. You can find your nearest SARC here.

8.3. Mental Health Support

Samaritans[23]– They offer a 24/7 listening service, their telephone number is 116 123 and email jo@samaritans.org. If you are struggling with your mental health and need the space to talk to someone free of judgement, when in crisis, you can contact them.

Shout[24] – A 24/7 text-based service that offers support to anyone struggling to cope (text 'shout' to 85258).

Student Minds[25] and **Student Space** offer online advice and information to help any student struggling with their mental health.